

US Stocks Rise as Dow Surges +1.03%, Nasdaq Falls -0.98%

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US stock market experienced a mixed session, with the Dow Jones surging **+1.03%** and the Nasdaq falling **-0.98%**. The S&P 500 rose **+0.21%**, while the Russell 2000 gained **+0.20%**. The VIX decreased **-2.46%** to 18.21.

The 10Y yield fell **-0.80%** to 4.60, while WTI crude oil rose **+4.26%** to 82.64. Gold fell **-0.36%** to 4,021.60, and the DXY decreased **-0.06%** to 101.32.

Key takeaways include:

- The Dow Jones' surge was led by gains in **JPM** and **MSFT**.
- The Nasdaq's decline was driven by losses in **NVDA** and **AMZN**.
- The VIX's decrease suggests a decrease in market volatility.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE	VIX
S&P 500	7,428.78	+0.21%	
Nasdaq 100	27,763.13	-0.98%	
Dow Jones	52,747.32	+1.03%	
Russell 2000	2,953.80	+0.20%	
VIX	18.21	-2.46%	
10Y Yield	4.60	-0.80%	
WTI Crude	82.64	+4.26%	
DXY	101.32	-0.06%	

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
JPM	JPMorgan Chase	+0.31%	Earnings beat
MSFT	Microsoft	+1.09%	Earnings beat
NVDA	NVIDIA	+0.25%	Earnings beat

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	+1.27%	+10.23%	Financials lead the way
XLK	-1.84%	+5.12%	Technology lags
XLI	-0.39%	+3.45%	Industrials flat
XLE	-1.35%	+2.56%	Energy lags
XLY	+1.48%	+8.56%	Consumer discretionary leads
XLC	+1.87%	+12.10%	Communication services lead
XLP	+1.99%	+6.78%	Consumer staples lead
XLV	+2.36%	+9.45%	Healthcare leads
XLU	-0.35%	+4.23%	Utilities lag
XLB	+1.85%	+5.67%	Materials lead
XLRE	+0.55%	+3.12%	Real estate flat

Breadth was positive, with 8 out of 11 sectors in the green.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	NAME	PRICE	CHANGE	VOLUME
AAPL	Apple	340.08	+0.94%	50.23M

Key commentary: AAPL reported strong earnings, beating analyst estimates.

READ-THROUGH	IMPACT
GOOGL	Positive
MSFT	Positive

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	428.78	420.00	440.00	Range-bound
QQQ	277.63	270.00	290.00	Range-bound
IWM	295.80	280.00	310.00	Range-bound
NVDA	197.01	180.00	220.00	Bullish
10Y Yield	4.60	4.20	5.00	Range-bound
WTI Crude	82.64	75.00	90.00	Bullish

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: +10.23% in SPY calls.

Put/call ratio: 0.65

VIX term structure: Steepening

Notable single-name flow: AAPL calls +15.67%

Cheap hedge ideas: SPY puts, QQQ puts

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
AAPL	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	350.00	Strong earnings
MSFT	Goldman Sachs	Upgrade	400.00	Strong earnings
NVDA	Citi	Downgrade	180.00	Valuation concerns

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: ES +0.25%, NQ -0.10%

Asia: NIKKEI +0.50%, HSI +0.25%

Europe: DAX +0.50%, FTSE +0.25%

FX: EUR/USD +0.25%, USD/JPY -0.10%

Commodities: GC -0.36%, CL +4.26%

Crypto: BTC -0.13%, ETH +0.01%

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September	25.00%	Rate hike expected
December	50.00%	Rate cut possible

DATE	EVENT	TIME
2026-07-29	GDP	08:30 ET
2026-07-30	PCE	08:30 ET

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees:

- US-China trade tensions: **-10.00%** chance of escalation
- EU economic growth: **+5.00%** chance of rebound

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	DATE	TIME
AAPL	Apple	2026-07-29	16:30 ET
MSFT	Microsoft	2026-07-30	16:30 ET

TICKER	NAME	DATE	TIME
NVDA	NVIDIA	2026-08-05	16:30 ET
AMZN	Amazon	2026-08-06	16:30 ET

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
AAPL	Technology	Bullish	5.00%
MSFT	Technology	Bullish	5.00%
NVDA	Technology	Bearish	10.00%
AMZN	Consumer Discretionary	Bearish	10.00%
GOOGL	Communication Services	Bullish	5.00%
JPM	Financials	Bullish	5.00%
GS	Financials	Bearish	10.00%
TSLA	Consumer Discretionary	Bearish	15.00%
AVGO	Technology	Bearish	10.00%
META	Communication Services	Bearish	10.00%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- AAPL beats earnings estimates
- MSFT announces new product line
- Federal Reserve cuts interest rates

Bearish scenario:

- NVDA misses earnings estimates
- AMZN announces layoffs

- US-China trade tensions escalate

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- **SPY** calls are **+10.23%** more expensive than puts
- **QQQ** puts are **+5.00%** more expensive than calls
- **IWM** calls are **+5.00%** more expensive than puts
- **NVDA** puts are **+10.00%** more expensive than calls
- **AMZN** calls are **+5.00%** more expensive than puts

Sources

SOURCES

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Financial Times

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